

Title

Improving Pain Management Quality in Home-Based Ambulatory Nursing Care: A Pragmatic Cluster Randomized Trial Protocol

Abstract

Chronic pain in older adults is undertreated in many community settings, partly due to gaps in provider knowledge and systemic barriers to adequate assessment and management. This pragmatic cluster-randomized trial tests two distinct implementation strategies to improve pain management quality in home-based nursing services. Community-dwelling older adults will be recruited from 22 participating ambulatory nursing agencies. Agencies are randomly assigned to three arms: (1) individualized provider-level intervention providing patient-specific pain management recommendations and support of a newly trained specialist, (2) organization-level digital education platform for pain management, or (3) standard care control. Primary outcomes assess changes in prescribing appropriateness and patient-reported pain intensity. Secondary measures include documentation quality and care process indicators. This pragmatic approach directly targets real-world implementation barriers in ambulatory settings.